

Checklist for finalizing a paper draft (9/7/2024)

Before you send the final draft to your supervisor for revision

...or „How to improve the quality of your paper draft quickly“

No.	Task	Recommendation(s)	Done?
a	Search for "this", "these", "those", "their", "them", "it" etc. and remove it rigorously; substitute the terms with an article and/or noun (exceptions may be made, e.g. "THIS paper presents...")	16	
b	Search for personal pronouns and remove it rigorously by rephrasing	17	
c	Search for possessive case and remove it rigorously ("...the SYSTEM'S architecture...")		
d	Make sure that each sentence contains one (no more) messages and rephrase (typically shorten) the sentences accordingly; check the one-message recommendation on paragraph and section level	2	
e	Make sure every section includes an introduction and a transition to the next section, at least implicitly and that one-sentence paragraphs are avoided	3, 4, 6	
f	Make sure that every term is introduced; specifically, make sure that (i) every acronym is introduced once and (ii) every introduced acronym is used in the text	7, 8	
g	Check for non-restrictive attributive adjectives ("...the NEEDED data is used") and remove it by (i) deleting the adjective (if it is useless) or by (ii) rephrasing (if it is important)	13	
h	In case this is the first draft (typically paper structure definition) or the final draft, make sure you have given your draft to a colleague for thorough proof-reading	Common sense	
i	Check the introduction structure and contents: Never ever write a school-book-like explanation of the solution that nobody wants to read (reason for rejection); just explain, in an appropriate argumentation flow the approaches pursued so far to solve the problem with its pros and cons Friendly reminder: You may explain the solution (only if required to comprehend your approach) (i) in a background section or just mention it briefly (ii) in the introduction, (iii) in the methodology, or (iv) in the implementation	Section A.II	